

Daily Bible Note

Date: October 4, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 18:9-17

9 Now when Tou king of Hamath heard that David had defeated all the army of Hadadezer king of Zobah,

10 he sent Hadoram his son to King David, to greet him and bless him, because he had fought against Hadadezer and defeated him (for Hadadezer had been at war with Tou); and Hadoram brought with him all kinds of articles of gold, silver, and bronze.

11 King David also dedicated these to the Lord, along with the silver and gold that he had brought from all these nations—from Edom, from Moab, from the people of Ammon, from the Philistines, and from Amalek.

12 Moreover Abishai the son of Zeruiah killed eighteen thousand Edomites in the Valley of Salt.

13 He also put garrisons in Edom, and all the Edomites became David's servants. And the Lord preserved David wherever he went.

14 So David reigned over all Israel, and administered judgment and justice to all his people.

15 Joab the son of Zeruiah was over the army; Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder;

16 Zadok the son of Ahitub and Abimelech the son of Abiathar were the priests; Shavsha was the scribe;

17 Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and the Pelethites; and David's sons were chief ministers at the king's side.

II. Key Summary

- When Tou king of Hamath heard that David had defeated Hadadezer's whole army,

he sent his son Hadoram to greet and bless David, bringing all kinds of articles of gold, silver, and bronze (vv. 9-10).

- David dedicated those articles to the Lord, along with the silver and gold taken from Edom, Moab, Ammon, the Philistines, and Amalek; Abishai killed eighteen thousand Edomites in the Valley of Salt, David put garrisons in Edom, and the text says "the Lord preserved David wherever he went" (vv. 11-13).
 - David reigned over all Israel and administered judgment and justice to all his people, appointing Joab over the army, Jehoshaphat as recorder, Zadok and Abimelech as priests, Shavsha as scribe, and Benaiah over the Cherethites and Pelethites, with David's sons serving at the king's side (vv. 14-17).
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III. Passage Analysis

He kept none of what he received

When David received this acclaim from the nations he dedicated it all to the LORD. He knew that the praise and glory belonged to God, not himself. David could handle success as well as apparent failure. [1]

A foreign king sent gold, silver, and bronze to honor David, and David handed all of it straight over to God—nothing went into his own treasury. He knew exactly where it had come from: God gave him the victory, he did not win it on his own.

Winning abroad, fair at home

When David reigned over all Israel he executed judgment and justice among all his people. He was not so intent on his conquests abroad as to neglect the administration of justice at home. [2]

It is common enough for someone to look impressive in public and then treat their own people carelessly. David did not do that—he fought wars outside and still ran things fairly inside, with every role around him clearly assigned.

IV. Reflection Question

The last time you gave something of yours away—your allowance, a snack, an afternoon of your time—what did you give, and who did you give it to?

David dedicated all the gold and silver articles he took in battle to the Lord, keeping not one piece for himself.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, "1 Chronicles 18 – The Security of David's Kingdom", <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-18/>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry, "Commentary on 1 Chronicles 18", https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/1ch/1ch_018.cfm